Castaway Cove: Game Brief for Claude Code

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Castaway Cove is an epic ocean survival game for phones and the web: survive on a home island, build a raft, and sail to other islands for the tarps, bottles, scrap and blueprints that turn a shelter into a real base. The attached images are the art direction. Build what this brief describes, in the look those images show, and do not invent a style of your own.

This brief is for Claude Code. It describes what to build and how it should behave, not how to code it. A playable browser prototype already exists. The numbers below come from that prototype and are a tuning starting point, not final balance.

How to use this brief and the images

Attach the seven images with the file names below. Each image has one job, and where two disagree the later number wins.

File name	What it shows	How to use it
01-early-mood.png	A desert camp idle game with chunky icons and timers	Early mood reference for layout density and friendly icons only. Images 06 and 07 override it on colour and finish.
02-character-turnaround.png	The castaway from front, back, left, right and top, a head close-up and his palette	The player character's design. Cap worn backwards, full beard, black hoodie with tan straps, olive cargo pants, brown boots, tan backpack.
03-character-15-angles.png	The same castaway at 15 rotation angles	Source for directional sprites. Four poses are drawn facing the wrong way (see the note below).
04-palm-trees.png	Eight palm tree angles, an idle sway loop, a parts breakdown and a palette	Palm trees, the trunk-only stump, and coconuts.
05-inventory-ui.png	The inventory and character screen	Exact layout and materials for the Bag screen.

File name	What it shows	How to use it
06-island-concept.png	The island from above: camp, hut, chest, crates, fire, garden, sign, dock and raft	The world's look: terrain colours, props, and where camp sits. The island in the game is about 2.5 times bigger than shown.
07-fishing-pov.png	First-person fishing off the dock, with the full first-person HUD	Exact look for every first-person screen (fishing and fire lighting).

Facing rule for image 03. He wears his cap backwards, so on the angles drawn from behind the brim marks the back of his head. Judge facing by which side his beard shows on, not by the brim. The poses labelled 90°, 150°, 240° and 270° face the opposite way to their labels. Mirror them before use.

When art is missing. Produce it in the same style as these images, or leave a clearly labelled grey placeholder and list it as a needed asset. Never fill gaps with a different art style.

Pitch, pillars and platform

You wash up alone on a small tropical island with nothing. Fish and hunt for food, light fires to cook on, catch rainwater and bottle it, and build a base that keeps the weather and the wildlife out. The home island only gets you so far: build a raft, sail out across a shark-filled ocean, and loot other islands and wrecks for what you can't make at home. The long goal is to find a way off the ocean entirely.

Pillars

- **Hand-made look.** Every screen matches the reference images: painterly, muted, dark outlines, wood, parchment and leather interface.
- **Water is the clock.** Fresh water is scarce. Tarps, rain catchers and empty bottles decide how long you can stay out and how far you can sail.
- **The ocean is the map.** Each island has its own loot and danger, and the trip between them is a risk in itself.
- **A base worth protecting.** Storms, sun, night and animals wreck what you leave exposed, so upgrades are about protection, not decoration.
- **Short, satisfying actions.** Tap to walk, gather and build. Big moments (fishing, lighting a fire) zoom into hands-on first-person minigames.

Platform. Built to ship on the Google Play Store as an Android app, played in portrait with one thumb. The same build also runs in a desktop browser for quick testing, and an iOS release stays possible later. Target 60 fps on a mid-range Android phone from the last four years.

Recommended stack

- Phaser 3 with TypeScript, built with Vite. It's a 2D engine that runs in the browser and suits a top-down sprite game.
- Capacitor to package the game as a native Android app (and iOS later). This is the route to the Play Store, so set it up in the first milestone, not at the end.
- Sprites packed into texture atlases and bundled inside the app, so the game works fully offline. Keep all tuning numbers (rates, damage, costs, odds) in one data file so balance changes never need code changes.
- Saves stored on the device first. Cloud saves later through Google Play Games or Supabase.

If Claude Code believes another engine (for example Godot 4) fits better, it should say why before starting, not switch silently.

What we take from ocean survival games

The genre's best games share one loop: a moving base, scarce fresh water, and islands that each hold something you need. We borrow that loop and keep our own art, controls and minigames.

Game	What it does well	What we take
Epic Ocean Survival (mobile)	Raft as your base; a world map to sail between islands with their own story and hazards; water must be collected and food cooked; some recipes only found on islands; daily tasks and quests	World map travel, island-only recipes, named island types with a hook each
Raft (PC/console)	A hook pulls floating debris (planks, palm leaves, plastic); the raft expands piece by piece; water purifiers; a research table unlocks recipes; a radio receiver points to story islands; sails, anchors and engines to steer	Hooking flotsam at sea, a research table, a receiver that reveals story islands, sail and anchor upgrades

Game	What it does well	What we take
Stranded Deep (PC/console)	Fresh water is the hardest need; coconut water backfires if overused; a water still makes water over time; shipwrecks hold the best gear; storms can carry an unanchored raft away; an escape ending	Water scarcity and the coconut catch, a still, wreck diving, drifting rafts, a clear escape goal
Ocean Survival: Reborn (mobile)	Starts with "a raft and a rusty hook"; dive for treasure; workbench, cauldron and bed	Diving for loot, a simple starter kit

What players complain about, so we avoid it: forced ads that interrupt play, key materials locked behind random loot with no fallback, enemies that interrupt every action, and lost inventory bugs (from Epic Ocean Survival reviews). Every rare material needs at least one reliable source, and saves must be robust.

Art direction

The look is a hand-painted, slightly gritty cartoon: muted earth colours, soft painterly shading, and a dark brown outline around every object. Images 06 and 07 set the overall finish, and the character, tree and inventory sheets show how individual assets are drawn.

Rendering rules

- Every sprite has a dark brown outline (about #211912), thicker on the silhouette than inside.
- Shading is soft and painterly with visible texture: sand speckles, wood grain, rock facets, leaf veins. No flat vector fills, no gradients that look digital.
- Camera is top-down at a three-quarter angle, matching image 06. Objects stand up from the ground and are sorted by their foot position, so things lower on screen draw in front.
- Night, rain and storms are colour overlays and particles over the same art, not separate art sets.

Palette (sampled from images 06 and 07; match the images, not just these values)

Use	Colour
Deep water	#2B524C
Shallow water	#56806A

Use	Colour
Wet sand	#7F6A3F
Dry sand	#AD8549
Camp dirt	#A07940
Grass	#585322
Grass edge and shadow	#3F3C18
Rock	#6F6A62
Wood, dark and light	#5A3D27, #7A5233
Parchment	#DCC08A
Outline	#211912
Health bar	#D63A2C
Energy bar	#E3A52A
Water bar	#3F8FD0
Primary button	#6F9A3C with a #1D2A14 border

Interface materials (from images 05 and 07)

- Panels are dark worn leather and wood with a thick dark outline and a bottom drop shadow.
- Messages and result cards are parchment with a dark wooden frame and a rivet in each corner.
- The close button is a square wooden tile with a red X. The main action is a large green button with white condensed capitals.
- Inventory slots are recessed square tiles with a stack count badge in the bottom-right corner.

Typography. Headings, buttons, labels and numbers use a bold condensed sans in capitals (Oswald is close to the images). Longer explanatory text uses a rounded, friendly sans (Nunito is close).

Don't

- Don't use bright saturated cartoon colours, glossy UI, or emoji.
- Don't redraw the character, trees or props in a different style. Cut them from the images or draw new ones to match.
- Don't use thin outlines or flat vector shapes for world objects.

The home island

Each run generates a new, irregular round island from a seed, about 20 player-heights across (roughly four phone screens wide). Camp always sits on the west coast with a dock and moored raft just south-west of it, laid out like image 06.

Terrain, from the outside in

1. Deep sea. Swimmable up to a fixed distance offshore, then an invisible limit.
2. Shallows: a lighter band of water hugging the coast, with a foam line that breathes with the tide.
3. Wet sand, then dry beach with speckles, pebbles, shells and starfish.
4. Grass interior with a dark, ragged edge where it meets the sand, flowers and grass tufts.
5. About ten sandy clearings scattered inland so the grass never looks like one flat sheet.
6. The camp clearing: packed dirt, with a worn dirt path running down to the dock.

Resources (counts for one island; scale with island size)

Node	Count	Where	Gives
Palm tree	about 45 coastal, 15 inland	Coast and interior	Wood, coconuts
Rock	about 25	Anywhere inland	Stone
Berry fern	about 35	Anywhere inland	Fiber, berries, seeds

Camp layout, matching image 06. The camp fire is the centre.

- **Shelter / hut:** up and to the right of the fire.
- **Supply chest and crate:** up and to the left.
- **Map sign and barrel:** to the left.
- **Rain catcher:** up-left.
- **Garden:** down and to the right, inside a rope fence, with the scarecrow beside it and a watering can.
- **Dock:** down-left at the shore, with the raft tied to its far end.

Unbuilt structures show a dashed outline on the ground labelled with what goes there ("Shelter spot", "Fire pit"). Keep trees and rocks out of camp and away from the dock.

The ocean, other islands and sailing

The home island sits at the centre of a generated archipelago of about ten islands. Islands further out are bigger, richer and more dangerous, so each trip is a step up in risk and reward.

World map. A parchment map in the same style as the minimap in image 07. It starts mostly blank and fills in as you sight or visit islands. Message-in-a-bottle notes and the radio receiver mark new islands on it.

Island types

Island	Size	What it's for	Main danger
Home island	Medium	Your base, garden, rain catchers, storage	Lizards, monkeys, gulls, bugs
Sandbar	Tiny	Coconuts, crabs, washed-up bottles and plastic	Sharks close to shore, no shelter in storms
Jungle island	Large	Hardwood, vines for rope, a freshwater stream (must be boiled), wild pigs to hunt	Snakes, wild pigs that charge, monkeys
Rocky atoll	Medium	Stone, seabird eggs, scrap metal on the rocks	Crabs, slippery rocks, big waves
Shipwreck reef	Small island plus a wreck	Tarps, rope, empty bottles, nails, tools, blueprints, a cooking pot	Sharks guarding the wreck, limited breath when diving
Abandoned fishing camp	Medium	Blueprints for nets and a sail, batteries, map pieces, a bow	Raiding monkeys, a nest of snakes
Lighthouse island (story)	Large	The endgame: repair the lighthouse radio or reach the shipping lane	Storms, the toughest wildlife

Sailing. You sail the raft in real time across a top-down ocean, in the same painted style as the island.

- **Controls:** steer by tapping a direction or dragging. A paddle moves you slowly in any direction; a sail is much faster with the wind and slow against it. A wind arrow on the HUD shows direction.

- **At sea:** floating crates, planks, plastic, bottles and tarps drift past. Throw a hook to pull them in.
- **Sharks:** they circle the raft and bite chunks out of it. Each plank has health. Fight them off with a spear or repair the plank before you sink.
- **Storms:** waves push the raft off course and can wash loose items overboard. Drop the anchor to hold position.
- **Landing:** reaching an island's shallows lets you beach the raft and walk ashore. An unanchored raft drifts away if left too long (Stranded Deep's rule), so anchor it or pull it onto the sand.
- **Range:** you can only go as far as your water and food last. Trips need bottles of water, food and repair materials packed before you leave.

The raft is a second base. It starts as four log tiles with a paddle. Add floor tiles to grow it, then a storage crate, a tarp roof (shade and rain cover), a rain catcher, a fishing net that slowly fills, a small cooking fire on a stone slab, a sail, an anchor and a steering oar.

The player

The player controls one castaway, drawn from images 02 and 03, who walks, swims, dives, climbs onto the raft and works with his hands. Four bars keep him alive: health, food, water and energy.

Movement and facing

- Tap the ground to walk there; tap a tree, rock, animal or structure to walk over and use it. On desktop, WASD or arrow keys also move him.
- He faces the exact direction he's moving using the 15 angles from image 03, and turns smoothly through the in-between angles instead of snapping.
- When walking sideways, use the front three-quarter poses so his face shows. Only use back poses when he heads clearly up the screen.
- Standing still for half a second, he turns three-quarters toward the camera. While chopping, fishing or fighting he faces the target.
- Walking needs a real walk cycle: legs step in turn, a slight body bob, no side-to-side waddle. Image 03 only has standing poses, so walk frames per direction are a needed asset (see the assets section).

Water

- Walking into the sea starts swimming: about half speed, energy drains fast, and only his head and shoulders show above a ripple ring.
- Swimming draws sharks. He can only fight back weakly (spear at half damage).

- Hold the dive button over a wreck or reef to dive. A breath bar drains, and he must surface before it empties. Diving is how wreck loot is reached.
- The dock and the raft are solid. He can walk along the dock, step onto the raft, or swim up and climb aboard. Sharks can't reach him on either.

Stats (prototype values as a starting point; one in-game day is about 2.7 real minutes)

Stat	Starts at	Drains	Refills	At zero
Health	100, +5 max per level	Attacks, storms without cover, starving, thirst, drowning	Being well fed, resting in shelter, cooked food	Run ends
Food	100	Steadily; 1.7 times faster in a heatwave	Eating; cooked food fills most	Lose health over time
Water	100	Steadily; 1.8 times faster in a heatwave	Bottled water, coconuts, rain, the rain catcher	Lose health over time
Energy	100	Walking, working, fighting; swimming fastest	Resting under shelter, sleeping in a hut or bed	Move and gather 35% slower; drowning if swimming
Breath	100	Only while diving	Surfacing	Forced to surface, lose health

Status effects (shown in the Bag's Status tab)

Effect	Cause	What it does
Well fed	Food above 70	Slow health regen
Sheltered	Standing under a roof	Health and energy regen, no storm damage
Wet	Rain or swimming with no shelter	Energy drains faster until dry by a fire
Sick	Raw meat, unboiled stream water, too many coconuts	Food and water drain faster for a while
Bleeding	Shark bite or a deep cut	Slow health loss; sharks find you faster

Effect	Cause	What it does
Poisoned	Snake bite, bad fish	Health loss until cured with herbs
Exhausted	Energy below 15	Slower movement and work

Levels. Gathering, fishing, harvesting, hunting, building and exploring give experience. Each level adds max health and attack damage.

Survival: water, food, weather and night

Fresh water is the hardest need and the main limit on how long you can stay out at sea. Food is easier to find but has to be cooked, and weather decides what is safe to do today.

Water loop

1. **Find a tarp** (washed up on beaches, hooked at sea, or in wrecks) and **empty bottles** (beaches, floating debris, wrecks, the fishing camp).
2. **Build a rain catcher** at camp or on the raft: a tarp stretched over four sticks, tied with rope, draining into a barrel. It fills while it rains, faster in storms.
3. **Fill bottles** at the rain catcher. A bottle of water is the portable form: drink it for a big water refill and you get the empty bottle back.
4. **Carry bottles on trips.** How many full bottles you have is roughly how many days you can spend at sea.

Water source	How	Gives	Catch
Coconut	Gather from palms, drink from the Bag	Water and a little food	More than three in a short time makes you Sick
Standing in rain	Be outside when it rains	A trickle of water	Makes you Wet
Rain catcher	Tap it, or fill bottles from it	Water from its tank	Only fills in rain; tank has a limit
Bottle of water	Drink from the Bag	Large refill, bottle returned	Bottles are rare loot
Stream (jungle island)	Fill a bottle	Dirty water	Must be boiled in a cooking pot first, or you get Sick
Solar still	Tarp, stones and a bottle over seawater	A bottle of fresh water every so often	Slow; faster on clear days

Water source	How	Gives	Catch
Seawater	Never drinkable	Nothing	Drinking it costs water

Food loop

- **Fishing:** the first-person minigame from the shore, the dock or the raft, plus a raft net that slowly catches small fish on its own.
- **Hunting:** crabs on beaches (easy), seabirds and their eggs, lizards, and wild pigs on the jungle island that charge when hurt. Kills drop raw meat, plus feathers, bone or hide for crafting.
- **Foraging and farming:** coconuts, berries from ferns, and vegetables from the garden (cabbage, carrots, tomatoes, as in image 06).
- **Cooking:** raw fish and meat must be cooked on a lit fire. Raw meat has a chance to make you Sick. A cooking pot makes stews that combine ingredients for bigger refills.
- **Spoilage:** fresh fish and meat spoil after about two days. A drying rack turns them into jerky that keeps far longer, which is the food you take on long trips.

Day and night. A full day is about 2.7 minutes in the prototype; aim for 8 to 12 minutes in the real game. Night is dark except around fires and the player. Lizards hunt harder, bugs swarm, and sleeping in a hut skips to dawn.

Weather changes every minute or two, with a forecast shown 20 seconds before.

Weather	Effect
Clear	Normal; solar still works fastest
Overcast	Normal, dimmer
Rain	Rain catchers fill, crops grow twice as fast, you get Wet outside, fires burn down faster
Heatwave	Food and water drain much faster, crops grow at half speed; shade helps
Storm	Health loss outside shelter, exposed structures take damage, fires burn down fastest, big waves at sea

Death. When health reaches zero the run ends with a summary (days survived, animals fended off, fish caught, islands visited) and a button to start again.

Gathering, inventory and crafting

Players tap a resource to walk over and work it, carry what they find in a limited bag, and turn it into tools, structures and raft parts. Rare materials come from other islands, which is what pulls players out to sea.

Gathering. Tapping a palm, rock or fern walks him over and works it in one-second swings with a progress ring. Each node gives a few uses, then becomes a stump, rubble or bare stalks and regrows after about a minute. Floating debris at sea is pulled in with the hook.

Materials

Material	Where it comes from
Wood, palm leaves, coconuts	Palm trees on every island
Hardwood, vines	Jungle island trees
Stone	Rocks; more on the rocky atoll
Fiber, berries, seeds	Ferns and bushes
Rope	Crafted from fiber or vines
Tarp	Beaches after storms, floating crates, wrecks
Empty bottle	Beaches, floating debris, wrecks, the fishing camp
Plastic	Floating debris, sandbars
Scrap metal, nails	Wrecks, the rocky atoll, the fishing camp
Cloth	Wrecks, the fishing camp
Feathers, bone, hide	Hunting birds, fish, pigs
Battery	The fishing camp, the lighthouse island
Blueprint	Wrecks and story islands; unlocks a recipe at the research table
Message in a bottle	Washes up on beaches; reveals an island on the world map and a line of story

The Bag screen is image 05 exactly: two panels side by side on wide screens, stacked on phones. Opening it pauses the game.

- **Left panel, Inventory tab:** Pockets (10 slots) and Backpack (4 slots, upgradable). Each slot holds a stack of one item, with the count in the corner. Tap a slot to select it, then use Use, the amount toggle (one or the whole stack) and the bin (tap twice to confirm).

- **Left panel, Craft tab:** every recipe as a card with its cost; missing materials shown in red; locked recipes say what unlocks them.
- **Right panel header:** level badge, the player's name (tap the pencil to rename), an experience bar, and the day.
- **Right panel, Loadout:** the character in the centre holding his weapon, with attack and defence underneath. Slots on the left: weapon, tool, backpack, one accessory. Slots on the right: cap, hoodie, pants, boots. Better clothing can be found or crafted later (a tarp poncho cuts Wet; a wide hat cuts heat).
- **Right panel, Status tab:** the active status effects with what each does.
- **Bottom bar:** health, energy, water and food meters.
- When the bag is full you stop picking things up and get a warning.

Crafting stations. Simple items are made by hand. Better tools and furniture need a workbench. New recipes from blueprints are learned at a research table (Raft's model).

Item	Made from (starting costs)	Station	What it does
Rope	3 fiber	Hand	Ties everything together
Fishing rod	3 wood, 3 fiber	Hand	Unlocks fishing
Stone spear	4 wood, 3 stone	Hand	More than double damage, longer reach
Stone axe	2 wood, 2 stone, 1 rope	Hand	Faster chopping; needed for hardwood
Throwing hook	2 rope, 1 scrap	Hand	Pulls floating debris to you
Knife	2 scrap, 1 wood	Workbench	Faster gutting and hide from hunts
Bow and arrows	Blueprint, 3 hardwood, 2 rope; arrows from wood and feathers	Workbench	Ranged hunting and shark defence
Cooking pot	Found in a wreck, or 6 scrap	Workbench	Boils water, cooks stews
Torch	1 wood, 1 fiber, 1 cloth	Hand	Carried light at night; keeps bugs off
Bigger backpack	2 hide, 2 rope, 1 cloth	Workbench	Backpack goes from 4 to 8 slots
Radio receiver	Blueprint, 6 scrap, 2 batteries	Research table	Points to story islands on the map

Camp and base building

The base exists to keep the weather and the wildlife out. Each upgrade protects you or your stores from something specific, and storms test what you've built.

Placing structures. Open Craft, pick a structure, then drag a ghost of it around the camp clearing: green where it fits, red where it doesn't. Tap to confirm. Small structures can also go on the raft once it has floor tiles.

Structure	Starting cost	What it protects or does
Lean-to	8 wood, 4 fiber	Rain cover; standing under it heals and rests you; blows down in a strong storm
Palm hut (image 06)	16 wood, 8 fiber, 6 stone	Full storm cover, faster healing; sleep to skip the night
Reinforced hut	Hut + 2 tarps, 20 wood, 10 nails	Survives every storm, adds a storage chest inside, keeps monkeys out
Campfire	5 wood, 3 stone; each lighting 2 wood, 1 fiber	Cooking, boiling, light at night, keeps bugs away, dries you off
Rain catcher	1 tarp, 4 wood, 2 rope (+ a barrel for a bigger tank)	Collects rainwater; fills bottles
Solar still	1 tarp, 4 stone, 1 empty bottle	Slowly turns seawater into fresh water
Drying rack	6 wood, 2 rope	Turns raw fish and meat into long-lasting jerky
Storage chest	10 wood, 4 nails	12 extra slots at camp; the supply chest in image 06 opens the Bag
Farm plot	3 wood, 2 fiber	Grows vegetables from seeds in three stages
Scarecrow	4 wood, 5 fiber	Keeps most birds off the crops
Spike fence	14 wood, 6 stone	Hurts lizards, pigs and monkeys that cross into camp
Workbench	10 wood, 4 stone	Unlocks better crafting
Research table	12 wood, 4 scrap	Learns blueprints

The fire must be lit. Building the fire pit leaves it unlit. Walking up to it shows a Light fire button, which opens the first-person fire minigame. A lit fire burns for about a day, twice as fast in rain and three and a half times as fast in a storm, then needs lighting again.

Storms damage the base. Every structure has durability. A storm chips away at anything without a roof over it, can blow down a lean-to, tear a rain catcher's tarp and flatten crops. Damaged structures show cracks and cost a few materials to repair. Better tiers resist more.

Wildlife raids the base. Monkeys steal from open storage and the player's bag, birds peck crops, lizards wander in at night. The scarecrow, the fence and the reinforced hut each counter one of these.

Garden. Plots sit inside a rope fence (image 06). Tap an empty plot to plant seeds, and tap a ripe one to harvest vegetables and get seeds back. Each plot takes three stages: rain doubles the speed, heat halves it, and night slows it.

Creatures and combat

Every creature has one clear job: some are food, some are pests, and sharks are the constant threat at sea. Combat stays simple so it never gets in the way of surviving.

Combat. He swings automatically at the nearest threat in reach, and tapping an animal makes him chase it. Bare fists do about 8 damage; the stone spear about 18 with a longer reach; each level adds 1. Clothing gives defence that cuts animal damage. The bow (later) adds ranged attacks for hunting and for keeping sharks off the raft. Hits knock animals back.

Creatures (prototype numbers where they exist; animals get about 8% more health each day survived)

Creature	Where	Behaviour	Damage	Drops
Shark	All open water	Circles offshore; lunges at anyone standing at the water's edge; hunts swimmers and bites; rams and bites raft planks; can steal a hooked fish	14 at the shoreline, 16 to swimmers	3 raw meat; teeth for crafting later
Lizard	Islands	Wanders by day, hunts at night	6, rising after day 3	1 to 2 raw meat

Creature	Where	Behaviour	Damage	Drops
Monkey	Home, jungle, fishing camp	Runs in, steals a stack from the bag or storage, flees for the shore; kill it to get the stack back	4 if there's nothing to steal	Raw meat and the stolen items
Gull	Everywhere	Dives at the player three times, or pecks crops back a stage	4	Raw meat, feathers, sometimes seeds
Bugs	Night and rain	Swarm the player; stay out of a lit fire's light	1.5 each, in swarms	Nothing
Crab (new)	Beaches, sandbars	Scuttles away; pinches if cornered	3	Raw meat; easy early food
Wild pig (new)	Jungle island	Grazes; charges when hurt	12	3 raw meat, hide
Snake (new)	Jungle, fishing camp	Hides in grass; bites when stepped near	5, plus Poisoned	Raw meat
Jellyfish (new)	Shallows on some islands	Drifts; stings swimmers	6	Nothing

Spawning. More animals the longer you survive, more at night, and never inside the camp fence or within sight of the player. Sharks per island grow from one to four over the first week. Story islands get tougher, "elite" versions of the same creatures.

First-person minigames

Fishing and fire lighting switch to a first-person view that looks exactly like image 07: painted scene, the player's own hand in front, and the first-person HUD over it. The world pauses while a minigame is open.

Fishing

A **Fish** button appears when the player stands at the water's edge, on the dock or on the raft with a rod. The foreground matches where he stands: sand from the shore, planks and the rope post from the dock (image 07), logs from the raft. The sky, sea and distant island follow the real time of day and weather.

1. **Cast.** Hold the button: a power bar sweeps up and down. Let go to cast. Longer casts reach bigger fish.
2. **Wait.** The float bobs for 2.5 to 6.5 seconds (shorter in rain or from the raft). Small nibbles twitch it; striking on a nibble scares the fish off.
3. **Hook.** When the float is pulled under, the button turns orange and pulses. Tap within about 0.85 seconds or the fish gets away.
4. **Reel.** Hold to reel and release to let line out. Holding raises line tension and pulls the fish in; releasing drops tension but lets the fish swim off. The fish fights in bursts that spike tension. A full tension bar snaps the line. If the reel-in bar empties, the fish escapes. A full reel-in bar lands it.
5. **Sharks.** If a shark is near the player, it may go for the hooked fish: a fin closes in over two seconds, and you lose the fish unless you land it first.
6. **Result card.** A parchment card shows the catch, its weight and the reward, with Cast again and Back to island.

Catch	Weight (kg)	Odds	Raw fish	XP	Fights
Sardine	0.1 to 0.4	Common	1	4	Weakly
Red snapper	0.8 to 3	Common	1	6	Moderately
Grouper	3 to 9	Uncommon; needs a medium cast	2	10	Steadily
Barracuda	2 to 7	Uncommon; needs a long cast	2	12	In violent bursts
Yellowfin tuna	8 to 25	Rare; long casts or the raft	3	18	Very hard
Golden trevally	4 to 12	Very rare	4	35	Hard
Old boot	1	Occasional	0	1	Barely

The dock and the raft count as deeper water, so they reach rarer fish than the shore. Later rods (better line from scrap) raise the snap limit.

Lighting the fire

A **Light fire** button appears at an unlit fire pit. It costs 2 wood and 1 fiber, taken only on success. The view looks down at the stone ring, built from the rocks in image 06, with a log teepee and a tinder nest. The player's hands and dark sleeves match the hand in image 07.

1. **Spin the drill.** Swipe left and right fast, or tap each side in turn, to spin a hand drill on a fireboard. A heat bar rises with each stroke and falls when you stop, faster in rain and storms. Smoke builds as it heats.
2. **Ember.** At full heat an ember forms and drops into the tinder nest.

3. **Blow.** Hold to blow. The ember glows brighter and the flame grows, but breath runs down. Run out and you cough and the ember dims. Let go to breathe, but don't let the glow die, or you're back to the drill with some heat kept.
4. **It catches.** The flames climb the logs, and a parchment card confirms the fire is lit.

This scene was built without a concept image. Make a concept for it in the same style as image 07 before final art (see the assets section).

HUD and screens

One visual language runs through every screen: the HUD from image 07, the Bag from image 05, and parchment cards for messages. The main island HUD uses the same parts as the first-person HUD, so nothing looks different when you zoom into a minigame.

Main HUD (on the island and at sea)

- **Top left:** the parchment-framed minimap with a home button (centres on camp), then the health, energy, water and food bars with their icons and numbers, then a pill for a key count (raw fish, or coins if a trader is added).
- **Top right:** a wooden day card (day number, time of day, weather icon, and the forecast when weather is about to change), with the goal panel underneath (yellow "!", short goal text).
- **Bottom:** an action bar of wooden square buttons: Bag, Build, Eat (with a food count badge), one context button, and Help.
- **Feedback:** short messages float up in a dark rounded pill above the action bar. Picked-up items float off the player ("+2 Wood"). Health below 30 pulses a red vignette.

The context button changes with where he stands.

Where	Button
At an unlit fire pit	Light fire
At a lit fire with raw food	Cook
At the water's edge, on the dock or on the raft, with a rod	Fish
Over a wreck or reef while swimming	Dive
Beside the beached or moored raft	Board raft / Set sail
At a rain catcher with empty bottles	Fill bottles

Sailing HUD adds a wind arrow, raft plank health, an anchor toggle and a throw-hook button, and swaps the minimap for the world map view.

Screens

- **Title:** game name in large display type over a painted island scene, Continue, New game.
- **Bag:** image 05 (detailed in the inventory section).
- **World map:** full-screen parchment map, discovered islands drawn and named, the raft's position, a dotted route of your trips.
- **First-person views:** image 07 for fishing and the matching fire scene.
- **Run summary:** parchment card with days survived, animals fended off, fish caught and islands visited.
- **Settings:** sound, music, vibration, and a left-handed layout that mirrors the action bar.

Every screen except the HUD pauses the game. All touch targets are at least 44 points, and everything works at 360 points wide.

Goals, progression and saves

A chain of goals teaches the game on the home island, then hands over to a story that pulls the player across the ocean. Progress is never lost to a bug or an update.

First-days goal chain (shown one at a time in the goal panel)

1. Gather 8 wood and 4 fiber.
2. Build a lean-to.
3. Craft a fishing rod and catch a fish.
4. Build a campfire, light it and cook your catch.
5. Find the tarp and bottles washed up on the beach. (Always place one tarp and two empty bottles on the home beach at the start, so the water loop never depends on luck.)
6. Build a rain catcher and fill a bottle.
7. Plant seeds in a farm plot.
8. Upgrade to a palm hut before the storms get worse.
9. Build a raft with a paddle and sail to the sandbar marked on your map.
10. Find a message in a bottle.

After the tutorial

- **Story:** messages in bottles carry lines from a previous castaway and mark new islands. The radio receiver points to the story islands. The ending is reaching the lighthouse island and repairing its radio to call for rescue. Players can keep playing after the ending.
- **Progression layers:** player level, blueprints learned, raft upgrades, base tier (lean-to, hut, reinforced hut), and island tier reached.
- **Repeatable goals:** optional daily tasks (catch 3 fish, fill 5 bottles, survive a storm) that reward a supply crate. Every rare material must have one reliable source besides these.

Saves

- Autosave every few seconds, when a screen opens, and when the app goes to the background. One run per save slot, with a Continue button on the title screen.
- Save everything needed to resume exactly: world seed, which islands have been visited and what's been taken from them, inventories, every structure with its durability, the raft's layout and position, time, weather, stats, the discovered map and goal progress.
- Version the save format and migrate old saves on update. Never wipe a player's progress because the game changed.
- Cloud save (for example Supabase with Apple and Google sign-in) is optional later.

Assets: what exists and what's needed

The seven images cover the character's look, palm trees, the inventory, the home island's props and the fishing view. Everything that moves, everything on the other islands, and the item icons still need art in the same style.

Already in the images (cut these out and reuse them)

- Character standing poses at 15 angles, turnaround and head close-up (02, 03).
- Palm trees at 8 angles, idle sway loop, trunk and coconuts (04).
- Hut, supply chest, crates, map sign, barrel, watering can, fire ring, garden with vegetables, rocks, ferns, starfish, dock, raft with sail (06).
- Fishing backdrop (sky, islet, sea), dock foreground with rope post and crate, the hand holding the rod, and all HUD parts (07).
- Inventory and character screen layout (05).

Still needed, in priority order

Asset	Detail
Walk cycle	6 to 8 frames for each of 8 directions, matching image 03
Action animations	Chop, mine, swing a weapon, eat, drink from a bottle, swim, climb onto the raft
Creatures	Shark (fin above water and full body below), lizard, monkey, gull, bug swarm, crab, wild pig, snake, jellyfish; each with move and attack frames
Item icons	Every material, food, tool and bottle state (empty, fresh, dirty), painted like the icons in image 05
Camp structures	Lean-to, reinforced hut, rain catcher with tarp and barrel, solar still, drying rack, storage chest, workbench, research table, scarecrow, spike fence, damaged versions of each
Farm	Empty plot, three growth stages each for cabbage, carrot and tomato
Raft parts	Floor tile, damaged tile, sail, anchor, net, storage crate, tarp roof, steering oar, as seen from above
Other islands	Jungle trees and vines, a stream, rocky atoll rocks, shipwreck above and below water, fishing camp shacks, the lighthouse
First-person concepts	The fire-lighting view and an underwater diving view, made to match image 07
World map	Parchment map frame, island icons, fog, route line
Title screen	Painted key art of the castaway, the raft and the islands
Weather effects	Rain, lightning flash, storm waves, heat shimmer, night overlay

Audio (none exists yet): waves and wind ambience by weather, jungle birds, rain on a tarp, fire crackle, reel click and splash, shark warning sting, gathering hits, UI clicks, and three music moods (calm day, tense night, storm).

Shipping on Google Play

The game is built to be published on Google Play from day one. Each item below shapes the build early, so Claude Code should treat them as requirements, not a final checklist.

Google's rules that apply (checked October 2026; confirm in Play Console at submission)

- From August 31, 2026, new apps and app updates must target Android 16 (API level 36) or higher (Android Developers).
- A new personal developer account (created after November 13, 2023) must run a closed test with at least 12 testers opted in for 14 days in a row before it can publish to everyone (Play Console Help). Line up 12 or more testers before the beta.
- Apps are uploaded as an Android App Bundle (AAB), signed through Play App Signing. Keep the upload key backed up safely.
- The store listing needs a privacy policy link, a completed Data safety form, a content rating questionnaire, an app icon, a feature graphic and phone screenshots.
- Any in-app purchase of digital items must use Google Play Billing.

What this means for the build

- **Package name:** choose it early (for example com.yourstudio.castawaycove). It can never change after the first upload.
- **Works offline:** all art and sound ship inside the app. No feature needs a connection except optional cloud save.
- **Android back button:** closes the open screen (Bag, map, minigame) or opens the pause menu on the main view. It never quits the game without asking.
- **App lifecycle:** going to the background pauses the game, mutes audio and saves immediately. Coming back resumes exactly where you were.
- **Screens:** lock to portrait. Respect notches, rounded corners and the gesture bar. Test on small (360 points wide) and tall phones and a tablet.
- **Performance:** hold 60 fps on a mid-range phone and stay playable at 30 fps on low-end ones. Watch memory from large textures.
- **Size:** keep the download under about 150 MB so it installs over mobile data comfortably.
- **Feel:** short haptic taps on hits, catches and the fire catching, with a setting to turn them off.
- **Privacy:** collect as little as possible. If crash reporting or analytics are added, they must be declared in the Data safety form and named in the privacy policy.
- **Age rating:** hunting and shark attacks are cartoon violence, likely rated around 7+ or 10+. Don't target children under 13, which would bring stricter Families policy rules on ads and data.

Store listing assets to produce: the app icon (in the image style, adaptive for Android), a feature graphic, 4 to 8 portrait screenshots (island camp, fishing view, Bag, sailing, a storm), a short and full description, and optionally a 30-second trailer.

Build plan for Claude Code

Build in eight milestones. Each one ends with a playable build on a phone and screenshots for review before the next starts.

1. **Foundations.** Project setup, the pipeline for cutting sprites from the images into atlases, one tuning data file, the camera, home island generation and painted terrain, the character with 15-angle facing, tap and keyboard movement.
   - Done when: walking around the home island at 60 fps on a phone looks like image 06.
2. **Survival core.** The four stats, day and night, weather, gathering with regrowth, the Bag screen (image 05), messages and the goal panel.
   - Done when: you can gather, see it in the Bag, and starve or dehydrate if you ignore your needs.
3. **Camp.** Crafting, structure placement, lean-to and hut, the fire pit with the fire-lighting minigame, cooking, the rain catcher and bottles, the garden.
   - Done when: the full water loop (tarp, catcher, fill, drink) and food loop (catch, cook, eat) work from a new game.
4. **Wildlife.** Every home island creature, combat, spawning, raids on the base, storm damage and repairs.
   - Done when: a storm night with an unprotected camp is dangerous and a reinforced one is safe.
5. **Into the water.** Swimming, diving, the walkable dock and raft, sharks hunting swimmers, and the fishing minigame (image 07).
   - Done when: every fish in the table can be caught, lost to a snapped line, or lost to a shark.
6. **Sailing.** Raft building and upgrades, the sailing view, wind, hooking debris, plank damage and repair, the anchor and drifting, the world map, the sandbar and the jungle island.
   - Done when: you can pack bottles and food, sail to the jungle island, loot it and sail home.
7. **The wider ocean.** The remaining islands, wreck diving, blueprints and the research table, messages in bottles, the radio receiver, and the lighthouse ending.
   - Done when: a full playthrough reaches the rescue ending.

8. **Polish and ship.** Audio, settings, save versioning, performance on low-end Android, the Google Play checklist (signed App Bundle, listing assets, Data safety, content rating, privacy policy), a 14-day closed test with 12 or more testers, and a balance pass from their feedback. Done when: the closed test passes and the production release is submitted.

Working rules for Claude Code

- The images are the art direction. Ask before changing any look, and never substitute a different style. Placeholders are grey and labelled.
- Every number (rates, costs, damage, odds, timings) lives in the tuning data file, never inside the code.
- Test every screen at 360 by 780 portrait and on a desktop browser.
- Don't add features that aren't in this brief without asking. Keep a backlog of ideas instead.
- No forced ads or anything that interrupts play.

Open questions for the owner

- How will the game make money: a paid app, free with cosmetics, or a trader and coins like the coin counter in image 07? Any purchase on Google Play has to go through Google Play Billing.
- Which Google Play developer account will publish it: a personal account (needs the 12-tester, 14-day closed test) or an organisation account?
- What package name and studio name should the app use? Both are permanent once published.
- How long should a day be in the final game (8 to 12 minutes suggested)?
- On death, is the run over (permadeath), or do you wake at camp and lose what you were carrying?
- Is the name Castaway Cove final, and is it free to use on the Play Store?
- Is multiplayer ever planned? This brief assumes single-player.